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QUICK GUIDE

CLEAN BULKING

The 10 principles you need to master to gain quality muscle — with the calculator that turns them into **your** numbers.

10 PRINCIPLES

CUSTOM MACROS

SAMPLE MENUS

WEEKLY CHECKLIST



10

PRINCIPLES

3 steps

TO YOUR MACROS

15

SWAPS

4 wks

OF TRACKING

BEFORE YOU START

Clean bulking is not about «eating a lot». It is about eating **just above** what you burn, with protein covered and training progressing. Everything else is noise.

+10–15%

ABOVE YOUR EXPENDITURE

2 g/kg

PROTEIN PER DAY

0,25–0,5%

WEIGHT GAINED/WEEK

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HOW TO GET THE MOST OUT OF IT

Read the guide through once. Then go back to page 4, work out your numbers and stick with them for **four full weeks** before changing anything. Adjusting every two days is the fastest way never to progress.

THE 10 PRINCIPLES OF CLEAN BULKING

01 Controlled surplus

10–15 % above your maintenance: roughly 300–500 kcal. A bigger surplus does not speed up muscle, only fat.

02 Protein comes first

1.8–2.2 g per kg of body weight, split across 4–5 servings of at least 0.4 g/kg each. It is the one macro that is not negotiable.

03 Strategic carbohydrates

4–6 g/kg per day, with most of it in the 2 hours before and the 2 hours after training.

04 Healthy fats

0.8–1 g/kg. Never drop below 0.6 g/kg: below that, hormone production suffers. Prioritise omega-3, avocado and extra virgin olive oil.

05 Real hydration

35–40 ml per kg per day, plus an extra 500–750 ml for every hour of training. Just 2 % dehydration already cuts your strength.

06 Quality over quantity

80 % minimally processed food, 20 % flexibility. That flexibility is not a reward: it is what keeps you here a year from now.

07 Calibrated patience

0.25–0.5 % of your body weight per week. For an 80 kg athlete that is 200–400 g a week. Gaining faster means gaining fat.

08 Sleep as a supplement

7–9 hours. 70 % of growth hormone is released while asleep, and three bad nights lower testosterone by up to 15 %.

09 Progressive overload

Every 1–2 weeks: +2.5–5 % weight, or one more rep at the same weight. If the logbook does not go up, neither does the muscle.

10 Honest tracking

Weigh your food for the first 4–6 weeks until your eye is calibrated. Weigh yourself daily and work with the **weekly average**, never with a single reading.

THE BEGINNER'S NUMBER ONE MISTAKE

Mistaking «bulking» for permission to eat without control. A 1,000 kcal surplus does not build twice the muscle of a 400 kcal one: it builds the same, with twice the fat and a much longer cut ahead of you.

WORK OUT YOUR MACROS IN 3 STEPS

STEP 1 · YOUR BASAL METABOLIC RATE (MIFFLIN-ST JEOR FORMULA)

SEX	FORMULA (WEIGHT IN KG · HEIGHT IN CM · AGE IN YEARS)
Male	$BMR = (10 \times \text{weight}) + (6.25 \times \text{height}) - (5 \times \text{age}) + 5$
Female	$BMR = (10 \times \text{weight}) + (6.25 \times \text{height}) - (5 \times \text{age}) - 161$

STEP 2 · MULTIPLY BY YOUR ACTIVITY LEVEL

LEVEL	FACTOR	DESCRIPTION
Sedentary	× 1,20	Desk job, no training
Light	× 1,375	1-3 sessions per week
Moderate	× 1,55	3-5 sessions per week
High	× 1,725	6-7 sessions per week
Very high	× 1,90	Two sessions a day or heavy physical work

STEP 3 · SPLIT THE MACROS

MACRO	AMOUNT	KCAL PER GRAM
Target calories	Maintenance + 300 to 500 kcal	—
Protein	$2.0 \text{ g} \times \text{your weight in kg}$	4
Fats	$0.9 \text{ g} \times \text{your weight in kg}$	9
Carbohydrates	$(\text{Calories} - \text{protein} - \text{fats}) \div 4$	4

WORKED EXAMPLE · MALE, 75 KG, 178 CM, 28 YEARS, MODERATE ACTIVITY

$BMR = 750 + 1,112 - 140 + 5 = \mathbf{1,727 \text{ kcal}}$ · Maintenance = $1,727 \times 1.55 = \mathbf{2,680 \text{ kcal}}$

Target = $2,680 + 350 = \mathbf{3,030 \text{ kcal}}$ · Protein 150 g (600 kcal) · Fats 68 g (612 kcal) · Carbohydrates $(3,030 - 1,212) \div 4 = \mathbf{455 \text{ g}}$

YOUR TABLE — FILL IT IN AND LEAVE IT ALONE FOR 4 WEEKS

FIGURE	VALUE	FIGURE	VALUE
Weight (kg)	_____	BMR	_____
Height (cm)	_____	Maintenance	_____
Age	_____	Target kcal	_____
Activity factor	_____	Protein / Fats / Carbs	_____

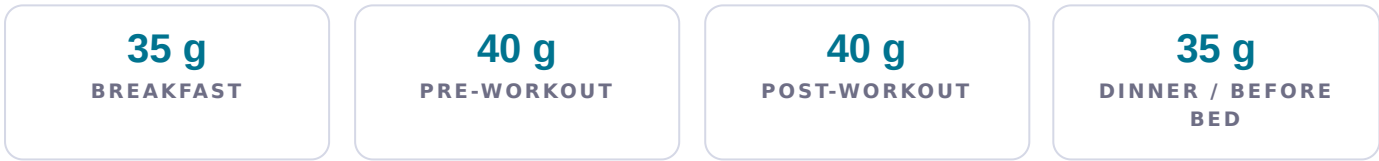
THE DAY, MEAL BY MEAL

Three interchangeable options for each point in the day: all three deliver an equivalent protein load.

MOMENT	OPTION A	OPTION B	OPTION C
Breakfast 07:00	Oats 80 g + 3 eggs	Omelette + wholegrain toast	Protein shake + fruit + nuts
Pre-workout 12:00	Rice 150 g + chicken 180 g	Pasta 130 g + tuna	Sweet potato 250 g + chicken breast
Post-workout 15:00	Protein shake + banana	Rice + chicken + fruit	Oats + protein + honey
Dinner 19:30	Salmon + vegetables + quinoa	Beef + salad	Chicken + broccoli + rice
Before bed 22:00	Cottage cheese + almonds	Greek yoghurt + nuts	Casein + milk

HOW PROTEIN IS SPREAD ACROSS THE DAY

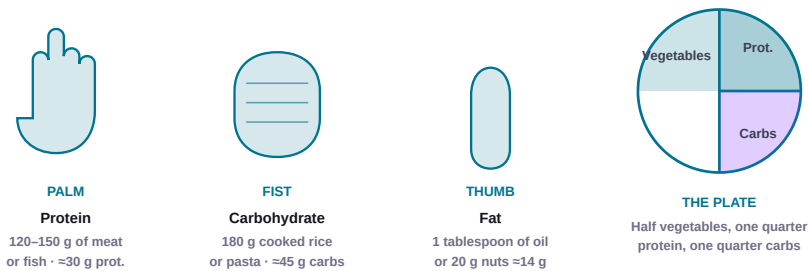
With a 150 g daily target, this is the distribution that maximises protein synthesis. Cramming 100 g into dinner achieves nothing.



QUICK SWAP TABLE

IF YOU HAVE NO...	SWAP IT FOR...	EQUIVALENCE
Rice 100 g (dry)	Pasta 100 g · Sweet potato 340 g · Potato 400 g	≈ 75 g of carbohydrate
Chicken breast 150 g	Turkey 150 g · Tuna 160 g · Hake 190 g	≈ 33 g of protein
1 scoop of protein	3 egg whites + 1 egg · 200 g Greek yoghurt	≈ 24 g of protein
Olive oil 10 g	Avocado 55 g · Almonds 15 g	≈ 9 g of fat
Oats 80 g	Wholegrain bread 100 g · Unsweetened cornflakes 70 g	≈ 48 g of carbohydrate

FIG. 1 PORTIONS WITHOUT SCALES



Every measure uses **your** hand, so it scales itself to your body size. This is the method for days when you eat out.

THE 8 MISTAKES THAT STALL YOUR PROGRESS

MISTAKE	WHAT IT CAUSES	FIX
Changing calories every week	You never know what was working because you never give it time to show	Hold the numbers for 2–3 weeks before touching anything
Weighing yourself on one day	Water and glycogen swing ± 1.5 kg without your fat changing at all	Weigh in daily, fasted, and compare weekly averages
Not logging oil and sauces	300–500 invisible kcal a day: the surplus doubles	Weigh your cooking fat for the first 4 weeks
Training with no load logbook	Without progressive overload, the surplus only produces fat	Write down sets, reps and weight for every session
Copying someone else's diet	Their calories match their weight, their height and their expenditure	Use the calculator on page 4 with your own figures
Excessive cardio «just in case»	It eats the surplus you work so hard to create	No more than 2 LISS sessions of 20–30 min per week
Sleeping 5–6 hours	Less testosterone, less recovery, more appetite	Treat 7–9 h as part of the plan, not as a luxury
Quitting in week 3	Visible change starts between week 6 and week 8	Commit to 12 weeks before judging results

THE GOLDEN RULE OF ADJUSTMENT

WHAT THE SCALE SHOWS OVER 2 WEEKS	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT YOU DO
Less than +0.3 kg	The surplus is too small	ADD 200 KCAL of carbohydrate
Between +0.3 and +1.0 kg	You are in the optimal range	CHANGE NOTHING
More than +1.0 kg	You are gaining excess fat	CUT 200 KCAL of carbohydrate

KEEP MEASUREMENT CONDITIONS CONSTANT

Always the same day (Monday), at the same time (as soon as you get up), after using the bathroom, fasted and without clothes. Changing the conditions invalidates the comparison.

WHERE EVERY NUMBER COMES FROM

Every number in this document comes from sources that are public, free and checkable. Not one figure is invented, rounded for convenience or copied from another popular publication. This page exists so that you can verify it yourself.

WHY THESE SOURCES AND NO OTHERS

Works of the United States federal government are not subject to copyright (17 U.S.C. § 105). That makes a handful of agencies the only source of nutrition and training data that is both first-rate and legally free. This is not restricted material: it is public material that almost nobody opens.

WHAT YOU ARE LOOKING FOR	WHAT YOU WILL FIND	WHERE
Reference intakes	RDA, AI and tolerable upper intake level for every vitamin and mineral	ods.od.nih.gov
Food composition	The full profile of any food, nutrient by nutrient	fdc.nal.usda.gov
Dietary guidelines	Dietary patterns and limits for added sugars, saturated fat and sodium	health.gov
Physical activity guidelines	The weekly dose, its response curve and the strength requirement	health.gov
Physical readiness doctrine	FM 7-22: training, nutrition, sleep and mental readiness	armypubs.army.mil
Lifting equation	How much weight is reasonable to lift in each specific situation	cdc.gov/niosh
Food safety	Safe internal temperatures and the danger zone	foodsafety.gov
Health claims	What may legally be claimed about a nutrient in Europe, and what was refused	European Commission register

HOW THIS DOCUMENT CHECKS ITSELF

The reference figures are not typed by hand: they live in a data module that the typesetting program verifies before writing a single line. It checks that the macronutrient ranges can add up to one hundred per cent of energy, that none of the 19 micronutrients has a recommended value above its own ceiling without a note explaining why, and that no safe cooking temperature falls inside the danger zone. If a single check fails, the document is not typeset.

REFERENCE VALUES ARE POPULATION VALUES

They describe what covers the needs of most healthy adults. They are not an individual prescription, they do not account for disease, pregnancy, breastfeeding or medication, and no publication replaces assessment by a registered health professional. If you take medication, some of the nutrients named here interact with it in clinically relevant ways: do not change an intake or start a supplement without telling whoever prescribes for you.

YOUR MONDAY CHECKLIST

- ☐ Fasted weight logged and weekly average worked out
- ☐ Waist measured at navel height
- ☐ This week's loads reviewed: has anything gone up?
- ☐ Days with protein fully covered: _____ of 7
- ☐ Average hours of sleep: _____
- ☐ Daily litres of water met
- ☐ Progress photo in the same light and pose
- ☐ Decision made: hold, add or cut 200 kcal

QUICK LOG FOR THE FIRST 4 WEEKS

WEEK	AVERAGE WEIGHT	WAIST	KCAL APPLIED	DECISION
Week 1	_____	_____	_____	_____
Week 2	_____	_____	_____	_____
Week 3	_____	_____	_____	_____
Week 4	_____	_____	_____	_____

THE PRINCIPLES DO NOT EXPIRE

Everything above rests on a single idea: a **small, measured surplus**. Repeat the cycle as many times as you like — each pass starts from more lean mass and from a better-calibrated calculation than the one before.

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